Exam Cell: Role Flow

How the Exam Cell seat works in the Faculty Management System, with illustrated screens.

1. What the Exam Cell is

The Exam Cell runs the examination side of a college. In the app it can configure how internal and external marks are split, publish mid-exam dates and timings, plan room-wise seating, publish circulars and guidelines, and view timetables and student attendance across the college. Its menu has no screens for managing student records, faculty records or leave approvals.

Exam Cell is a **seat**, not a separate kind of login. The person is a normal faculty member who holds the seat, so they sign in like any faculty member and land on the Panel Member home page. From there they use the **Working as** switcher at the top of the sidebar and choose **Exam Cell**. The sidebar then changes to the Exam Cell menu (Figure 1). The Principal appoints the seat from Role Assignments.

> All screens in this document are illustrations drawn from the page layouts, with placeholder names, dates and numbers. They contain no real college data.

2. End-to-end flow

Normally the work follows this order for each exam cycle:

1. Settings how many Mids → **2. Exam Configuration** Internal / External marks → **3. Mid Timings & Dates** publish schedule → **4. Exam Seating** rooms and benches →

5. Circulars & Guidelines tell everyone

Timetable View + **Attendance Reports** + **Staff Attendance**

are used alongside, to check timetables and to spot students below the attendance limit.

1. **Settings**: set how many mid-semester exams the college runs. This number decides which Mids (Mid 1, Mid 2, ...) can be chosen when timings are published.
2. **Exam Configuration**: pick a course, year, branch and exam type, then set the Internal and External marks and their breakdown once. It applies automatically to every subject taught under that course, year and branch. HODs and Panel Members can read these settings, and the HOD's Internal Exam page uses them when showing marks that faculty submitted.
3. **Mid Timings & Dates**: publish a date range and time window for each Mid, per course and semester. Entries can be edited or deleted after publishing. Principal and Vice Principal can read them.
4. **Exam Seating**: choose the exam name, tick the sections taking it, tick the rooms, and let the app allot seats. The rooms come from the room list that College Office maintains. The plan can be reviewed and printed.
5. **Circulars and Guidelines**: upload a PDF or Word notice, or type a short notice directly. Uploaded guideline documents are split into a point-wise list.

3. Who can see and change what

Area	Can change	Can read
Exam configurations	Exam Cell, Super Admin	Exam Cell, Principal, Vice Principal, Super Admin, HOD, Panel Member
Mid timings and dates	Exam Cell, Super Admin	Exam Cell, Principal, Vice Principal, Super Admin
Exam guidelines	Exam Cell, Super Admin	Exam Cell, Principal, Vice Principal, Super Admin
Exam seating plans	Exam Cell only	Exam Cell, Principal, Vice Principal

Source: the role lists in the exam-related API routes under src/app/api/college. The server enforces these; hiding a menu item is not what protects them.

4. Screen by screen

The last three screens (My Profile, My Leave, My Attendance) are the same for every faculty-type role.

Dashboard

`/exam-cell`

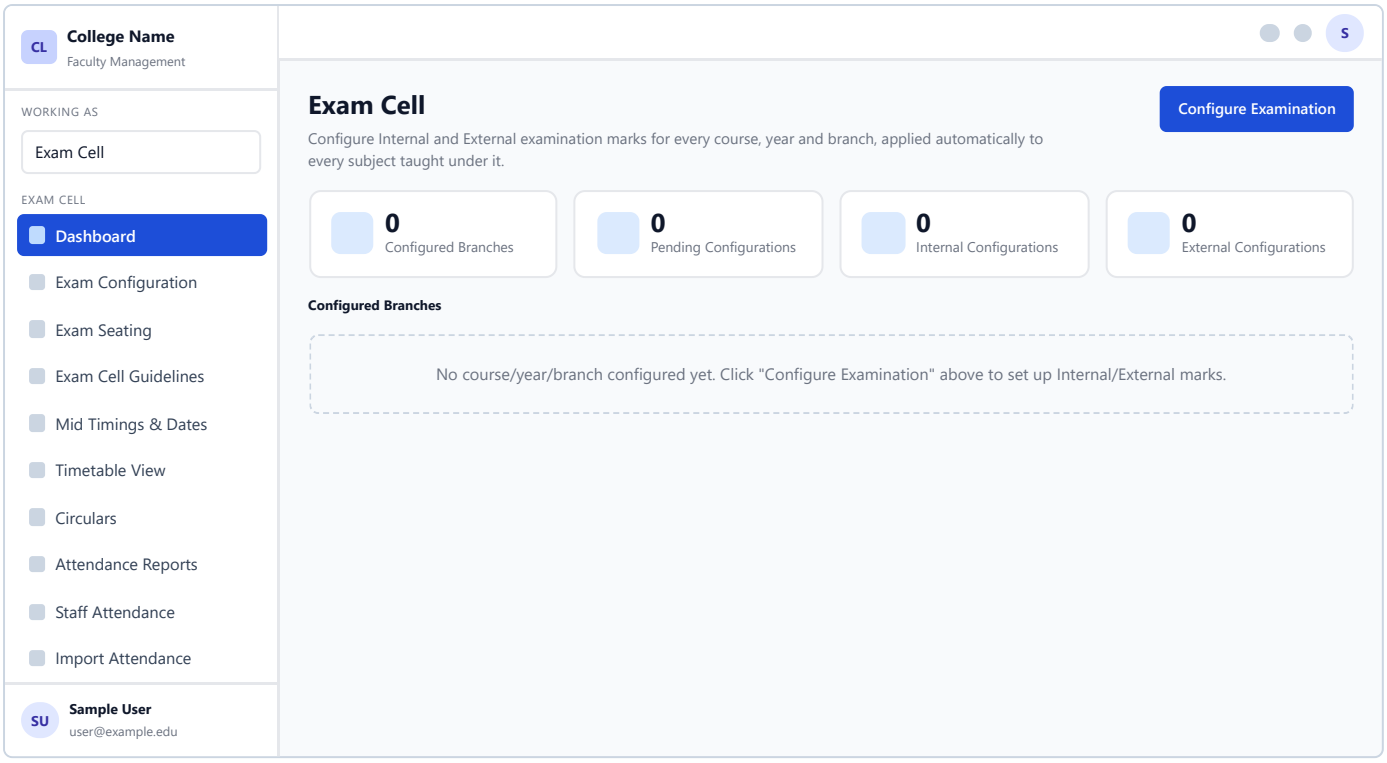


Figure 1. Dashboard (illustration with placeholder data)

The home page. Four counters show how far configuration has got: Configured Branches, Pending Configurations, Internal Configurations and External Configurations. Below them, Configured Branches lists each course, year and branch that already has marks set up. The **Working as** box at the top of the sidebar shows the seat in use.

What the user does here

1. Read the counters to see how much configuration is still pending.
2. Press **Configure Examination** to go straight to the configuration page.
3. Use the sidebar to move to any other Exam Cell screen.

> The counters show 0 in this illustration. On a live college they show real counts.

Exam Configuration

`/exam-cell/configure`

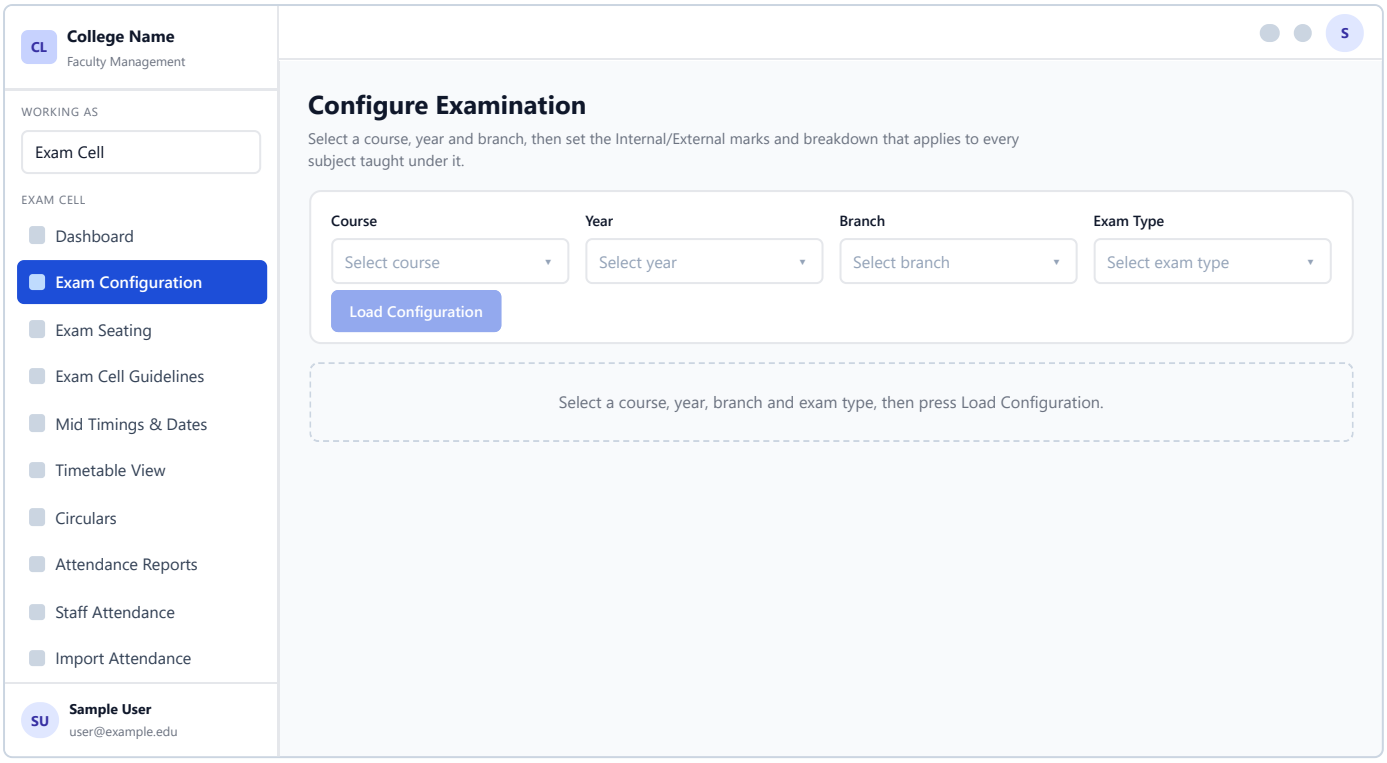


Figure 2. Exam Configuration (illustration with placeholder data)

Marks setup for a group of subjects at once. Choose Course, Year, Branch and Exam Type, then load the existing configuration.

What the user does here

1. Select a course, then a year, then a branch, then an exam type.
2. Press **Load Configuration**.
3. Set the maximum marks and the breakdown, then save. It applies to every subject taught under that course, year and branch.

> The Load button stays disabled until all four choices are made.

Exam Seating

`/exam-cell/seating`

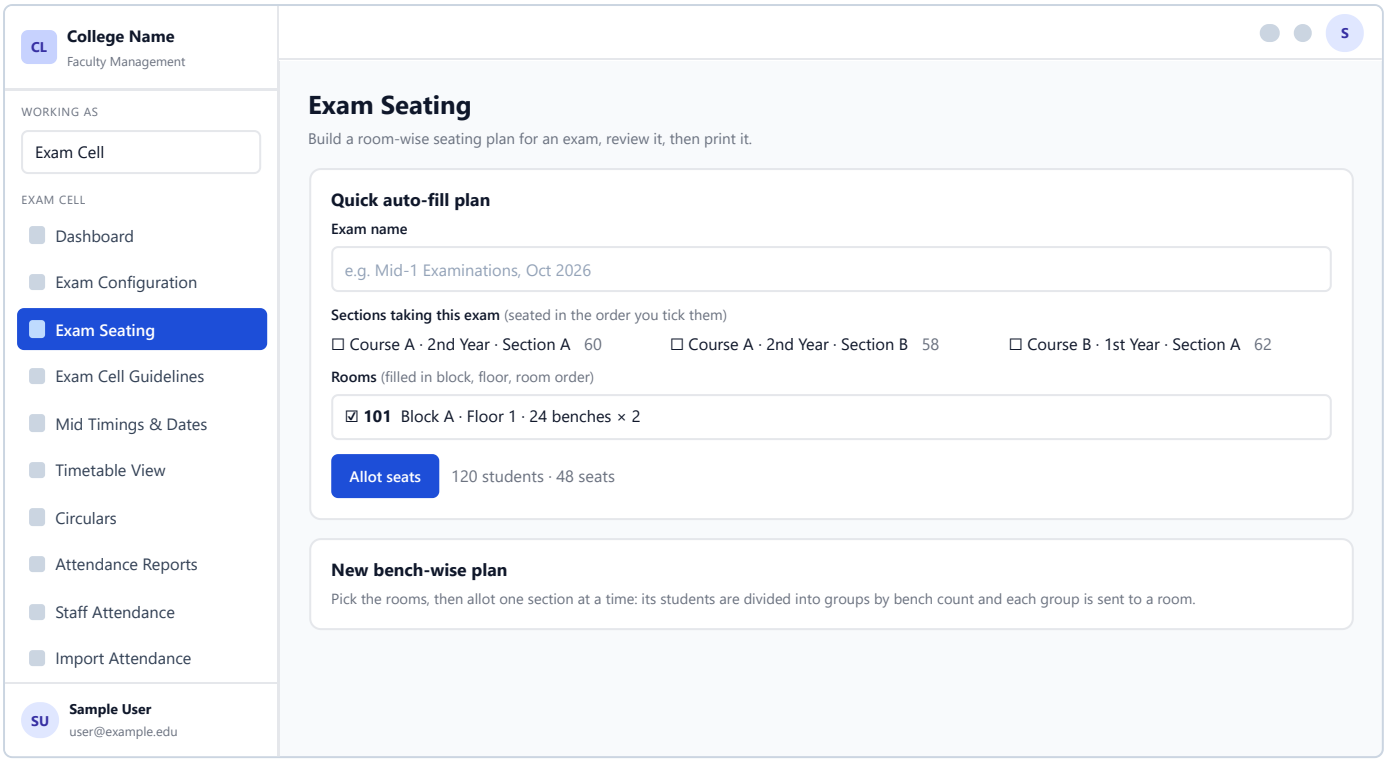


Figure 3. Exam Seating (illustration with placeholder data)

Builds a room-wise seating plan. The Quick auto-fill plan seats whole sections in the order they are ticked. A second panel, New bench-wise plan, divides one section at a time into bench groups.

What the user does here

1. Type an exam name, for example 'Mid-1 Examinations, Oct 2026'.
2. Tick the sections taking the exam. The number beside each is its student count.
3. Tick the rooms to use. They are filled in block, then floor, then room order.
4. Press **Allot seats**. The bottom of the form shows students against seats, so you can see whether the rooms are big enough.
5. Open the saved plan to review and print it.

> Allot seats stays disabled until the ticked sections have students. The rooms come from the room list that College Office maintains.

Exam Cell Guidelines

`/exam-cell/guidelines`

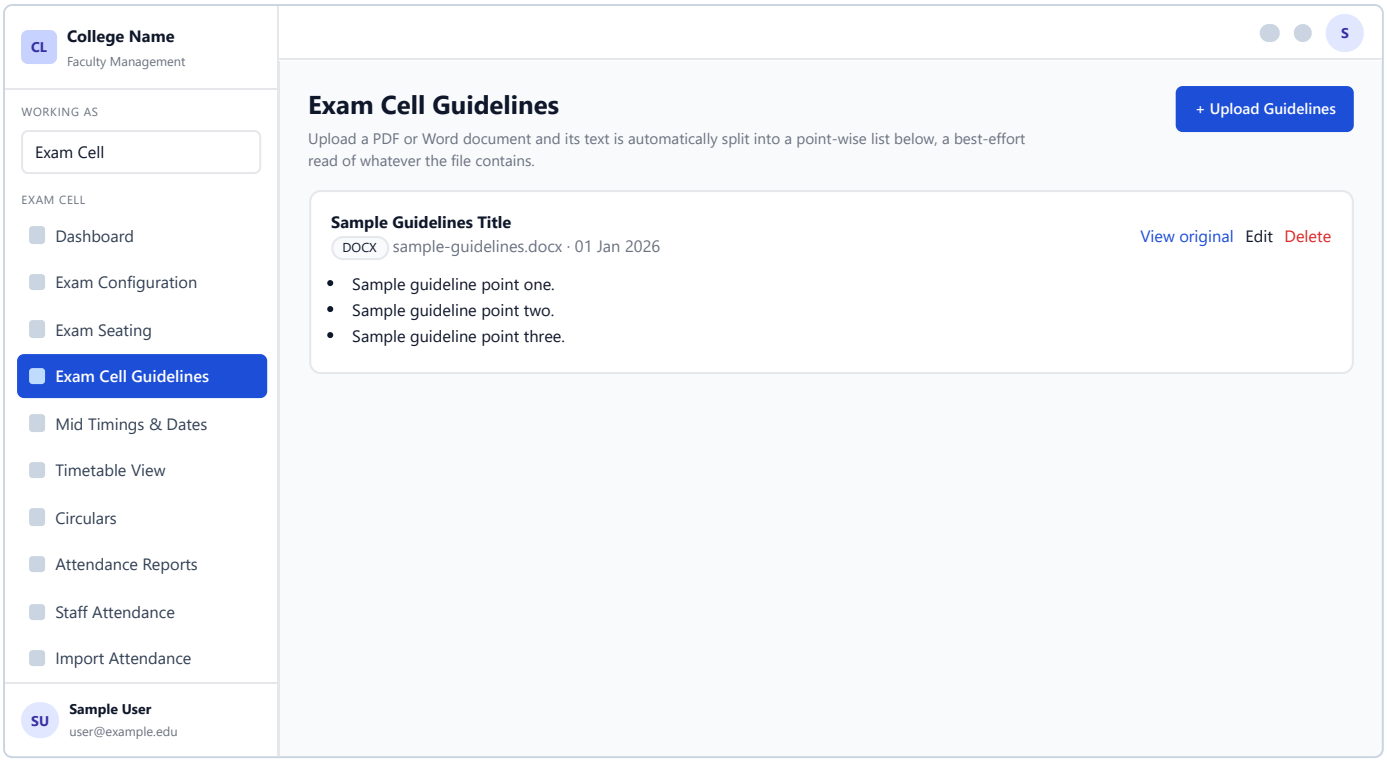


Figure 4. Exam Cell Guidelines (illustration with placeholder data)

A library of guideline documents. After a PDF or Word file is uploaded, its text is split into a point-wise list shown on the page.

What the user does here

1. Press **Upload Guidelines** and pick a PDF or Word file.
2. Review the extracted points, because the split is a best-effort reading of the file.
3. Use **View original** to open the uploaded file, **Edit** to correct the points, or **Delete** to remove it.

Mid Timings & Dates

`/exam-cell/mid-timings`

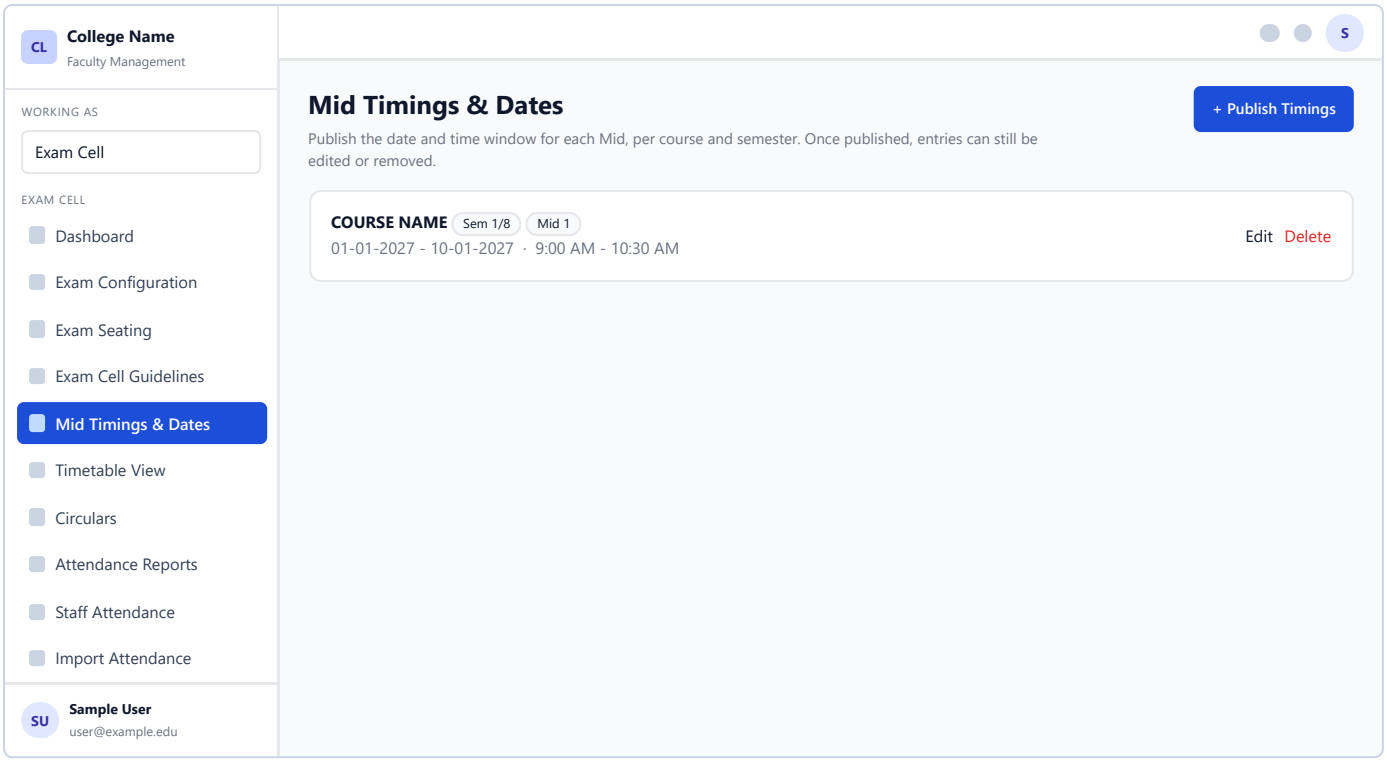


Figure 5. Mid Timings & Dates (illustration with placeholder data)

Publishes when each mid-semester exam happens. Each entry shows the course, semester, which Mid, the date range and the daily time window.

What the user does here

1. Press **Publish Timings** and choose the course, semester and Mid.
2. Enter the date range and the time window, then publish.
3. Use **Edit** or **Delete** on an entry if the schedule changes.

> The Mid choices (Mid 1 to Mid N) come from the number set on the Settings page.

Timetable View

`/exam-cell/timetable-view`

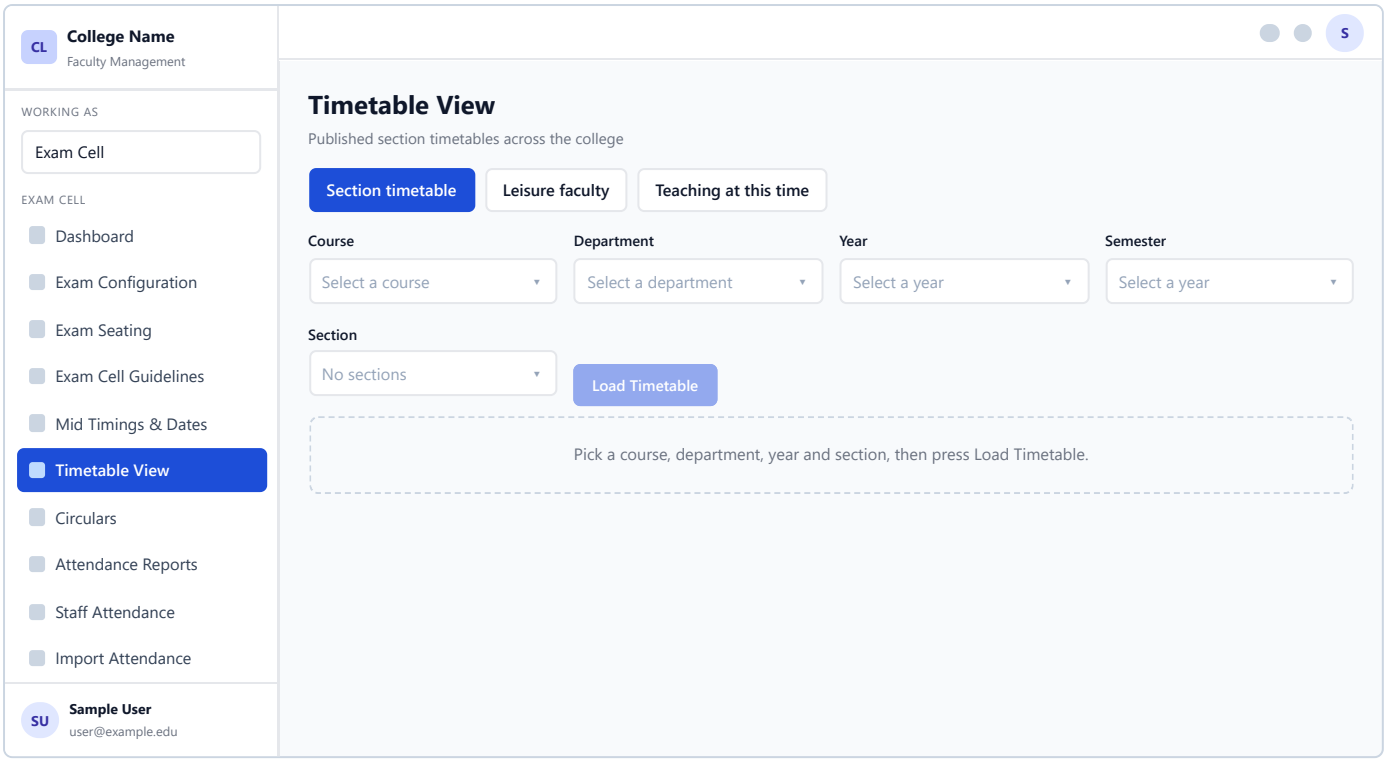


Figure 6. Timetable View (illustration with placeholder data)

A read-only view of published timetables across the college. It has three tabs: Section timetable, Leisure faculty and Teaching at this time.

What the user does here

1. On **Section timetable**, choose course, department, year, semester and section, then press **Load Timetable**.
2. Use **Leisure faculty** to find faculty who are free in a given period.
3. Use **Teaching at this time** to see who is in class at a given moment.

Settings

`/exam-cell/settings`

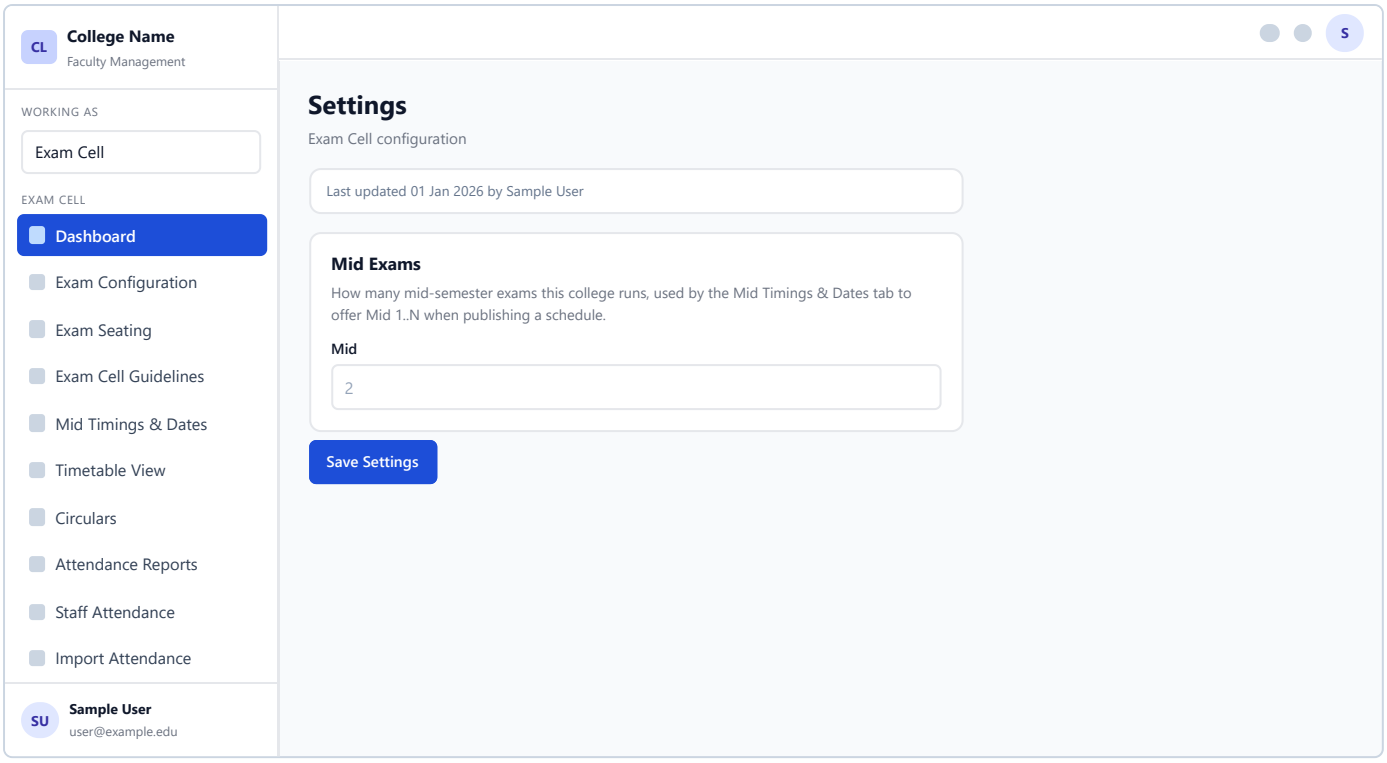


Figure 7. Settings (illustration with placeholder data)

College-level exam settings. At present it holds one value, the number of mid-semester exams the college runs. A line at the top shows who last updated it and when.

What the user does here

1. Change the Mid count.
2. Press **Save Settings**.

> Change this before publishing timings. Mid timings offer only Mid 1 to Mid N. Settings opens from the gear icon in the top bar.

Circulars

`/exam-cell/circulars`

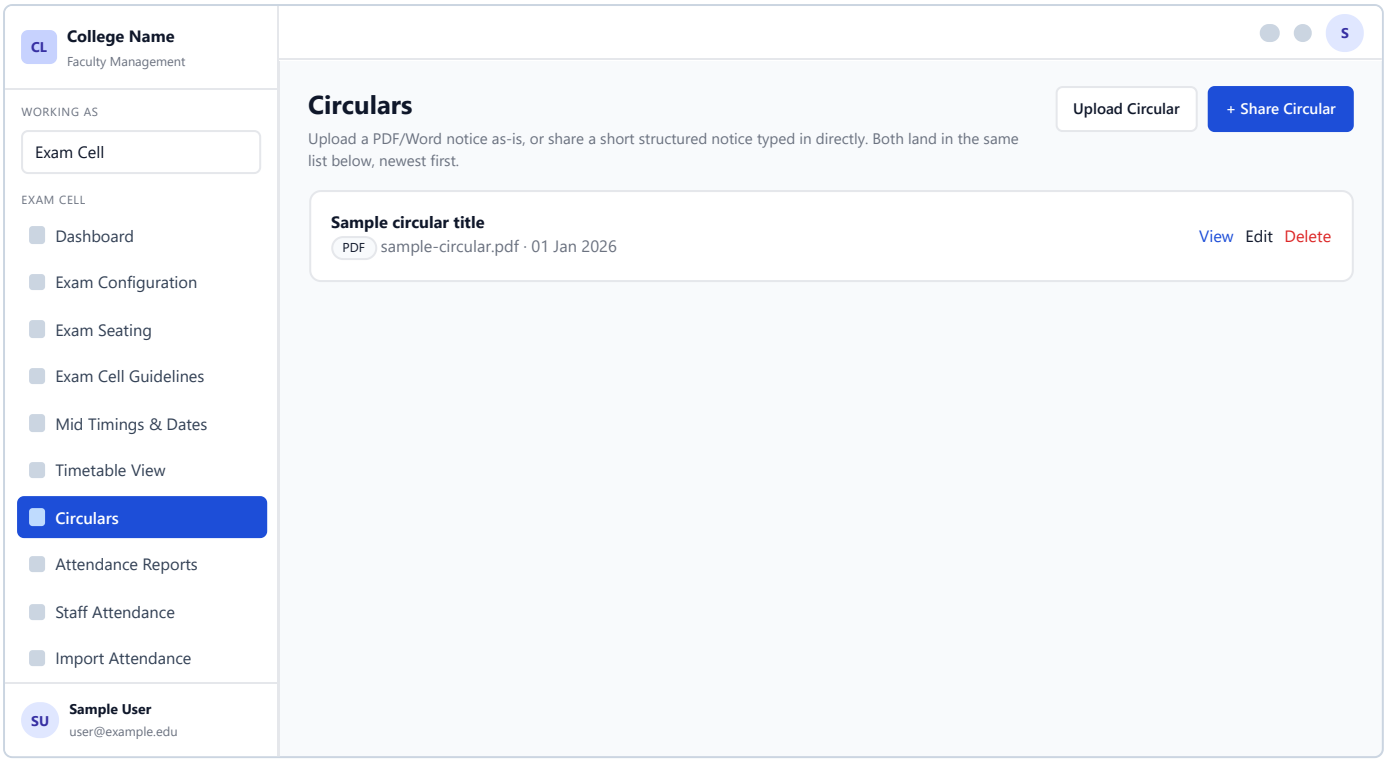


Figure 8. Circulars (illustration with placeholder data)

Notices from the Exam Cell. There are two ways to publish: upload a file as it is, or share a short structured notice typed in directly. Both land in the same list, newest first.

What the user does here

1. Press **Upload Circular** to attach a PDF or Word file, or **Share Circular** to type a notice.
2. Use **View** to open one, **Edit** to change it or **Delete** to remove it.

Attendance Reports

`/exam-cell/attendance-report`

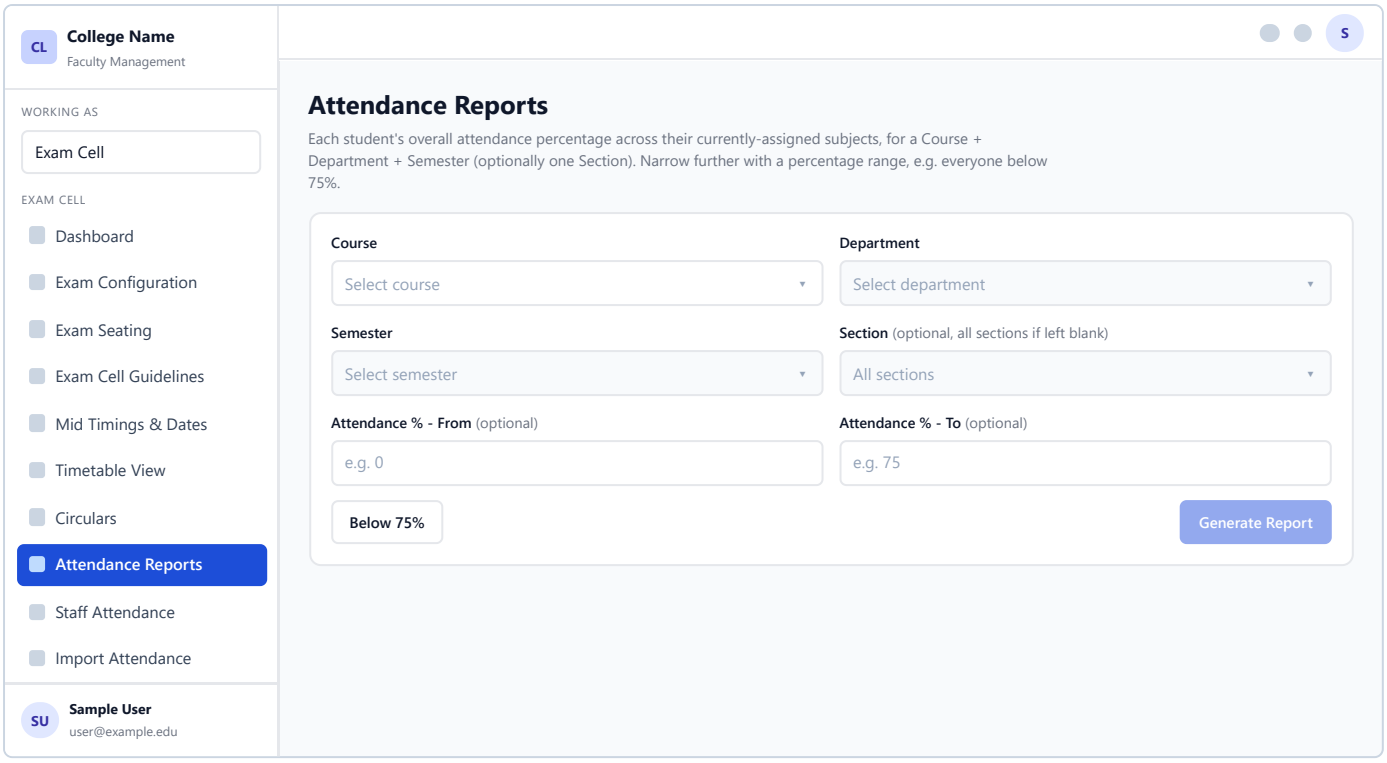


Figure 9. Attendance Reports (illustration with placeholder data)

Each student's overall attendance percentage across their currently assigned subjects, for a chosen course, department and semester. Use it before exams to find students who may be short of the attendance limit.

What the user does here

1. Select a course, department and semester. Section is optional and defaults to all sections.
2. Optionally enter a percentage range, or press the **Below 75%** shortcut.
3. Press **Generate Report**.

Staff Attendance

`/exam-cell/staff-attendance`

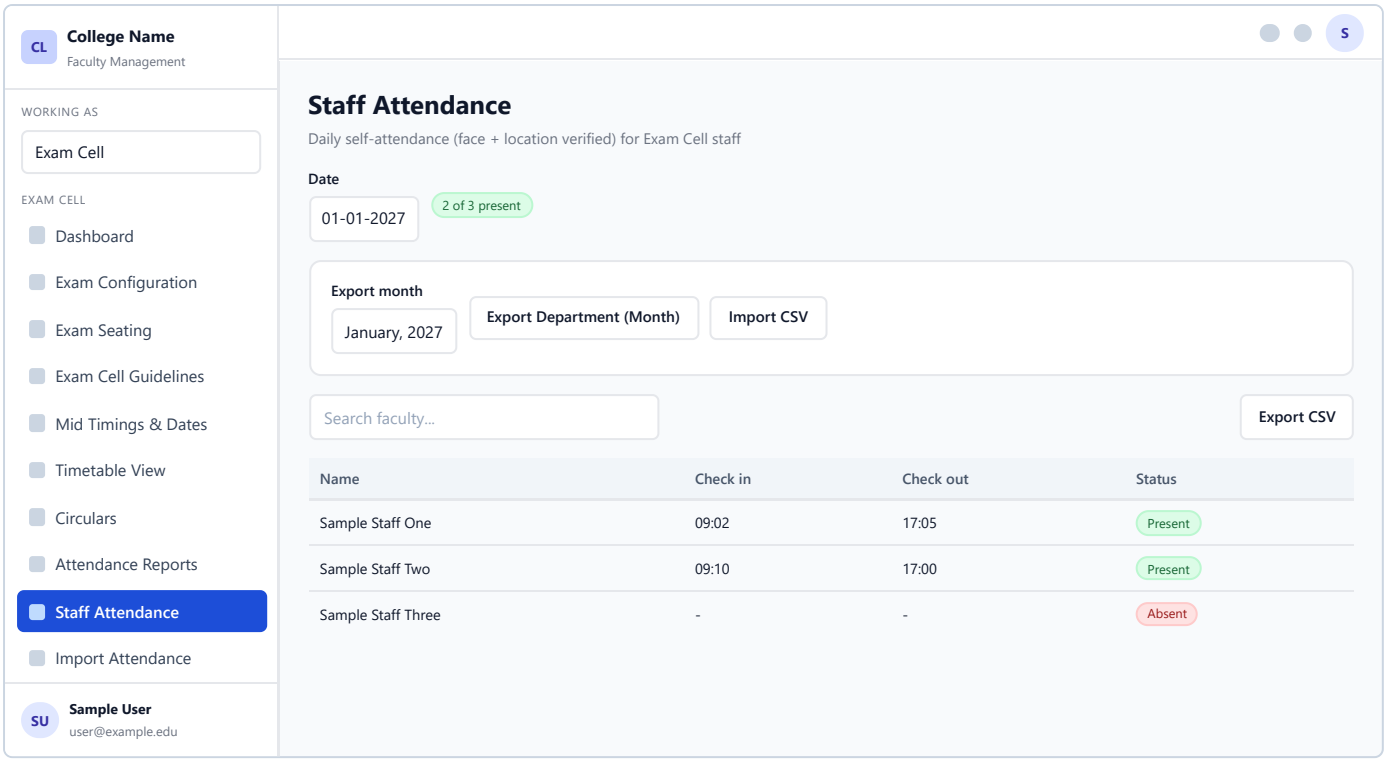


Figure 10. Staff Attendance (illustration with placeholder data)

Daily attendance of Exam Cell staff. Staff mark their own attendance with a face and location check, and this page shows who is present on the chosen date.

What the user does here

1. Pick a date. The count beside it shows how many are present.
2. Search for a person by name.
3. Use **Export Department (Month)** or **Export CSV** to download records, or **Import CSV** to load past records.

Import Attendance

`/exam-cell/attendance-import`

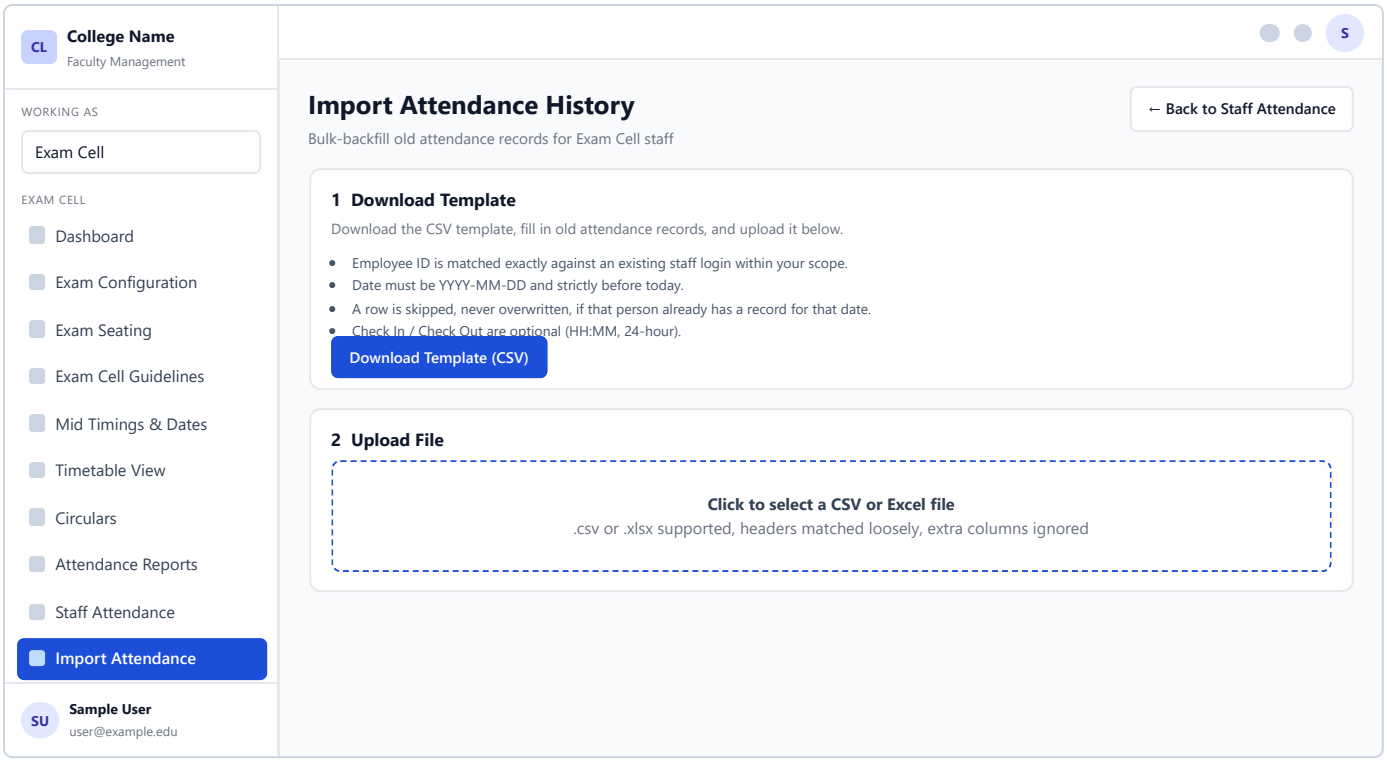


Figure 11. Import Attendance (illustration with placeholder data)

Bulk-loads old attendance records for Exam Cell staff, for days before today only.

What the user does here

1. Press **Download Template (CSV)** and fill in the old records.
2. Upload the file, either .csv or .xlsx. Headers are matched loosely and extra columns are ignored.
3. Review the result. A row is skipped, never overwritten, if that person already has a record for that date.

> Employee IDs must match an existing staff login within the Exam Cell's own scope, otherwise that row is rejected.

My Profile

`/exam-cell/profile`

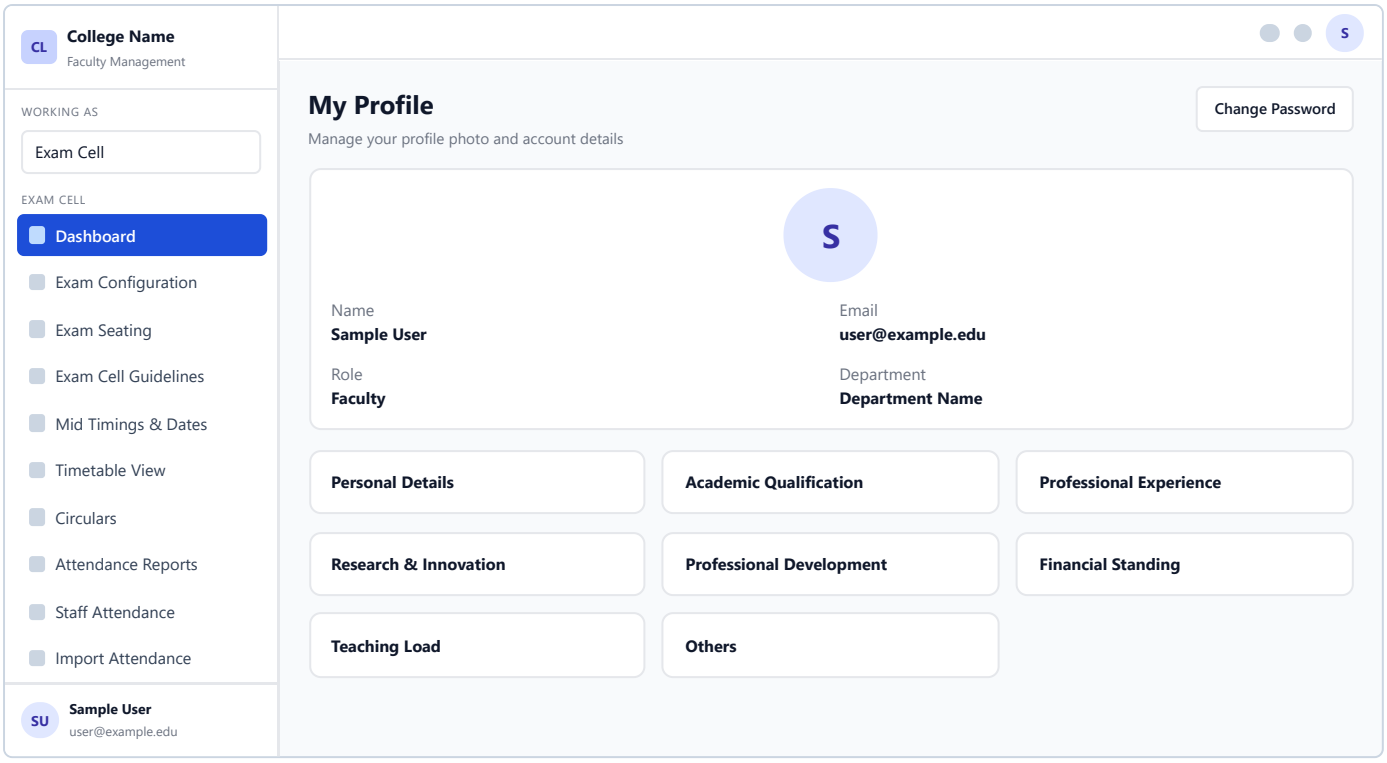


Figure 12. My Profile (illustration with placeholder data)

The person's own account page: photo, name, email, role and department, and a set of profile sections (Personal Details, Academic Qualification, Professional Experience and others).

What the user does here

1. Open any section card to view or edit that part of the profile.
2. Use **Change Password** to set a new password.

My Leave

`/exam-cell/leave`

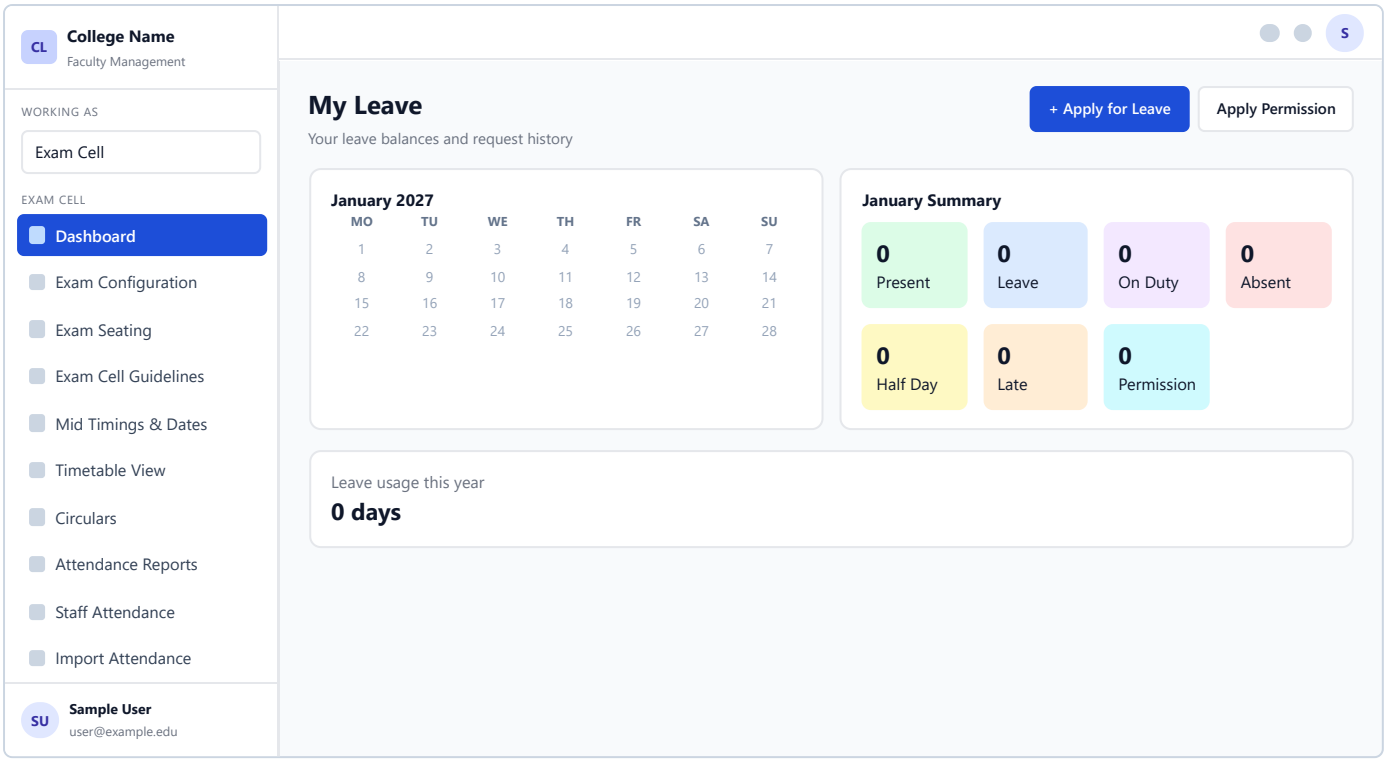


Figure 13. My Leave (illustration with placeholder data)

The person's own leave record: a calendar for the month, a summary of present, leave, on-duty, absent, half-day, late and permission days, the year's usage and the balance for each leave type.

What the user does here

1. Press **Apply for Leave** or **Apply Permission**.
2. Watch the request move through Awaiting decision, Approved or Rejected in the totals.

My Attendance

`/exam-cell/attendance`

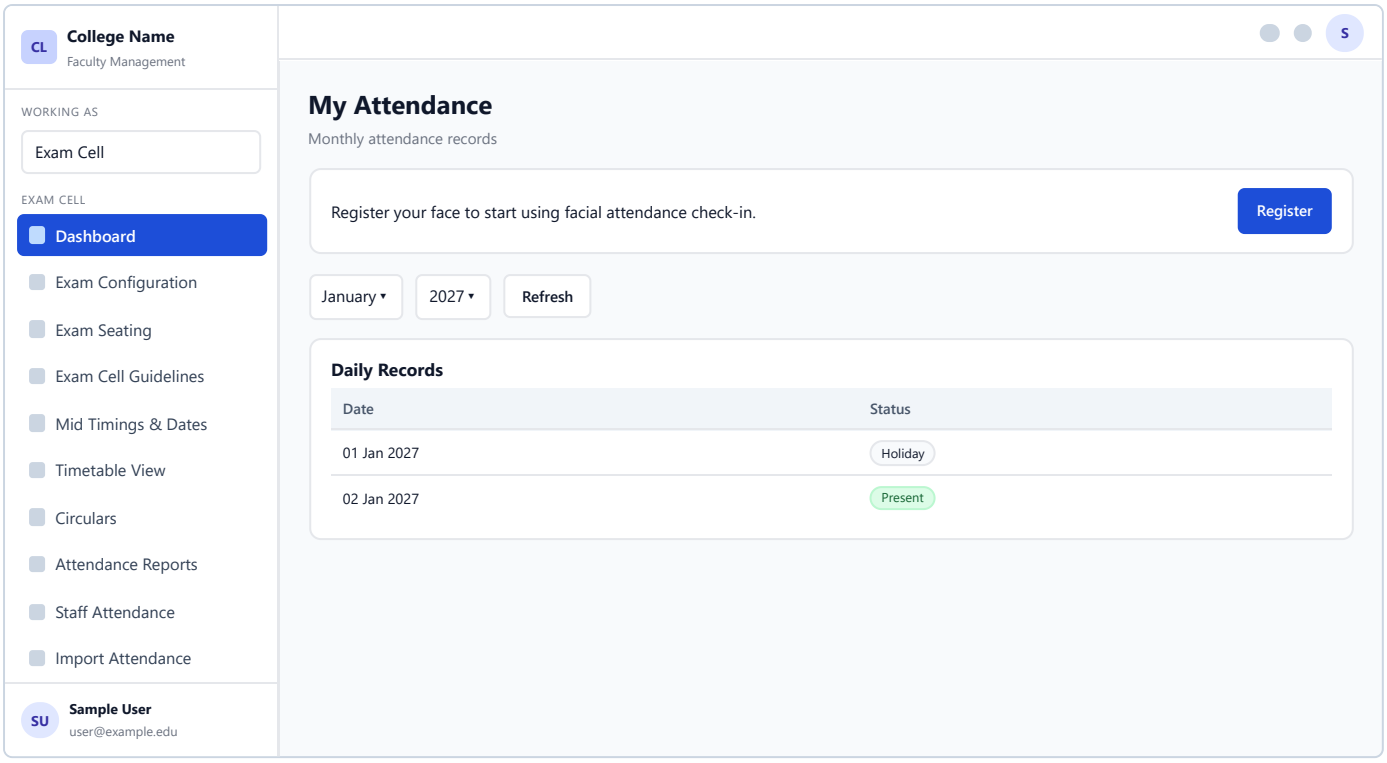


Figure 14. My Attendance (illustration with placeholder data)

The person's own monthly attendance records, with the face registration needed for facial check-in.

What the user does here

1. Press **Register** once to register the face.
2. Choose a month and year, then **Refresh** to see the daily records.